

Filling last-minute cancellations without the chasing

Today: a cancellation shows up in Square → you or Carla check the Google Sheet → text matching clients from the salon phone → track replies by memory.

What goes wrong

- **"We lose track of who we contacted and who's next"**, so the chair sits empty
- **Two clients both said yes** and one ended up upset
- **No set time to wait for replies**; it depends on whether someone remembers to follow up
- Most cancellations come **within 48 hours**, sometimes just hours before

What success looks like

- **Fewer openings sitting empty**
- **Much less time** chasing people and checking the sheet
- **No double-booking**

"The biggest thing is moving reliably to the next person without double-booking."

Lena

WHAT THE PROTOTYPE DOES

Post it once. It works through the list for you.

- 1

Slot opens. Staff post the service, stylist and time.
- 2

Best match gets the offer: right service, stylist and availability, earliest sign-up first.
- 3

They have 15 minutes to tap Yes or No.
- 4

Yes = booked. No or no reply = next person, automatically.

Juniper Salon

Fill cancelled appointments from the waitlist, one client at a time.

Post a cancelled appointment

Service

Cut & style

Stylist

Carla

Date & time

10/07/2026 10:00 AM

Reply window

15 minutes (salon default)

Start offering

Openings

Cut & style with Carla · Thu, Oct 8, 2:00 PM

Offer is with **Chloe Park** · 14:44 left to reply

1. Ava Thompson

Declined

2. Chloe Park

Has the offer

Open their text →

3. Finn Walsh

Waiting

Cancel current offer

Stop offering

► 5 not eligible

► Activity log

Workflow ID: opening-202610081400-0e340a

Staff see who has the offer and the time left, who declined or timed out, and who's next. They can also cancel an offer or stop.

If nobody accepts, the opening is marked Unfilled

Simulated text message from Juniper Salon

An earlier appointment opened up

Hi Chloe, a spot you asked for is available:

Service

Cut & style

Stylist

Carla

When

Thursday, October 8 at 2:00 PM

Please reply within 14:46

Yes, book me

No thanks

Clients see the appointment details, a countdown, and Yes / No.

2 / 5

HOW IT HANDLES THINGS GOING WRONG

The problems you described, handled automatically

"Depends on whether we remember to follow up"

It waits for each reply and **moves on by itself** after 15 minutes.

"Competing acceptances caused confusion"

Only one client can get the slot. A late "yes" is told it's no longer available.

"We lose track of who's next"

Every offer is recorded. **If the computer restarts mid-offer, it picks up where it left off**, and failed texts are retried.

The screenshot displays the Temporal UI for a workflow instance named 'opening-202610071400-33dcbb'. The top section shows workflow metadata: Start (Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:15.35 AM EDT), End (Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:25.64 AM EDT), Duration (10s 286ms), Run ID (01a114c8-a1bf-7ae2-87bc-36ce99d22206), Workflow Type (openingWorkflow), Task Queue (juniper-waitlist), History Size (13.58 KB), State Transitions (23), and Workflow SDK (Typescript 1.24.0). Below this is the 'Event History' tab, which lists 46 events. The events include Workflow Execution Completed, Workflow Task Completed, Workflow Task Started, Workflow Task Scheduled, Activity Task Completed, Activity Task Started, Activity Task Scheduled, and Workflow Execution Update Completed. The last event, 'Workflow Execution Update Completed', shows an outcome of 'no_longer_available' and a message 'Sorry, this...'. The event history is paginated, showing events 34 to 46.

Event ID	Timestamp	Event Type	Details
46	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:25.64 AM EDT	Workflow Execution Completed	Result: {"opening":{"id":"opening-202610071400-33dcbb","service..."}}
45	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:25.64 AM EDT	Workflow Task Completed	Identity: 37920@xiaoqilee
44	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:25.56 AM EDT	Workflow Task Started	History Size Bytes: 10560
43	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:25.52 AM EDT	Workflow Task Scheduled	Task Queue Name: 37920@xiaoqilee-61e2828e28174ea5bbb7b70459867b4b
42	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:25.52 AM EDT	Activity Task Completed	Result: [{"metadata":{"encoding":"YmluYXU5L251bGw="}}]
41	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:25.39 AM EDT	Activity Task Started	Attempt: 2
40	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:24.30 AM EDT	Activity Task Scheduled	Activity Type: sendText
39	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:24.30 AM EDT	Workflow Task Completed	Identity: 37920@xiaoqilee
38	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:24.22 AM EDT	Workflow Task Started	History Size Bytes: 8113
37	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:24.22 AM EDT	Workflow Task Scheduled	Task Queue Name: 37920@xiaoqilee-61e2828e28174ea5bbb7b70459867b4b
36	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:24.19 AM EDT	Activity Task Completed	Result: "SQ-33DCBB"
35	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:24.13 AM EDT	Activity Task Started	Attempt: 1
34	Oct 7, 2026, 1:14:24.22 AM EDT	Workflow Execution Update Completed	Outcome Success: {"outcome":"no_longer_available","message":"Sorry, this..."}

Behind the scenes: every offer is tracked. This filled opening's history even shows a text being retried and a late "yes" being turned away. (Powered by Temporal; we tested it by shutting the app down mid-offer.)

What's real, what's simulated, what's left out

Working now

- Matching and earliest-first order
- One offer at a time, 15-minute reply window
- Automatic move to the next person
- No double-booking; late replies told it's taken
- Stop / cancel controls and live status
- Staff adding clients to the waitlist

Simulated

- **Text messages:** shown as an on-screen page, not sent to real phones
- **Square:** cancellations are entered by hand; the booking is a pretend confirmation
- **Waitlist:** sample clients instead of your Google Sheet; resets when the app restarts

Not included yet

- Clients replying "YES" by text
- Staff logins
- Reports on filled vs. empty slots
- Rules like "only if 2+ hours' notice"

PRACTICAL NEXT STEP

Pilot it on Carla's cancellations for two weeks

What we'd do

- Send **real texts** from a salon number; clients reply YES or NO
- Load your current waitlist from the Google Sheet
- Carla posts each cancellation in the app (Square stays as-is)

What we need from you

- A copy of the waitlist sheet (so we match its columns)
- OK to text waitlist clients from a salon number
- 10 minutes with Carla at the end of each week

How we'll know it worked

- **Fewer empty chairs:** share of cancellations re-booked, vs. today
- **Less chasing:** staff time spent on follow-ups
- **Zero** double-bookings

If it works: connect Square so a cancellation starts the offers automatically, then roll out to every stylist.